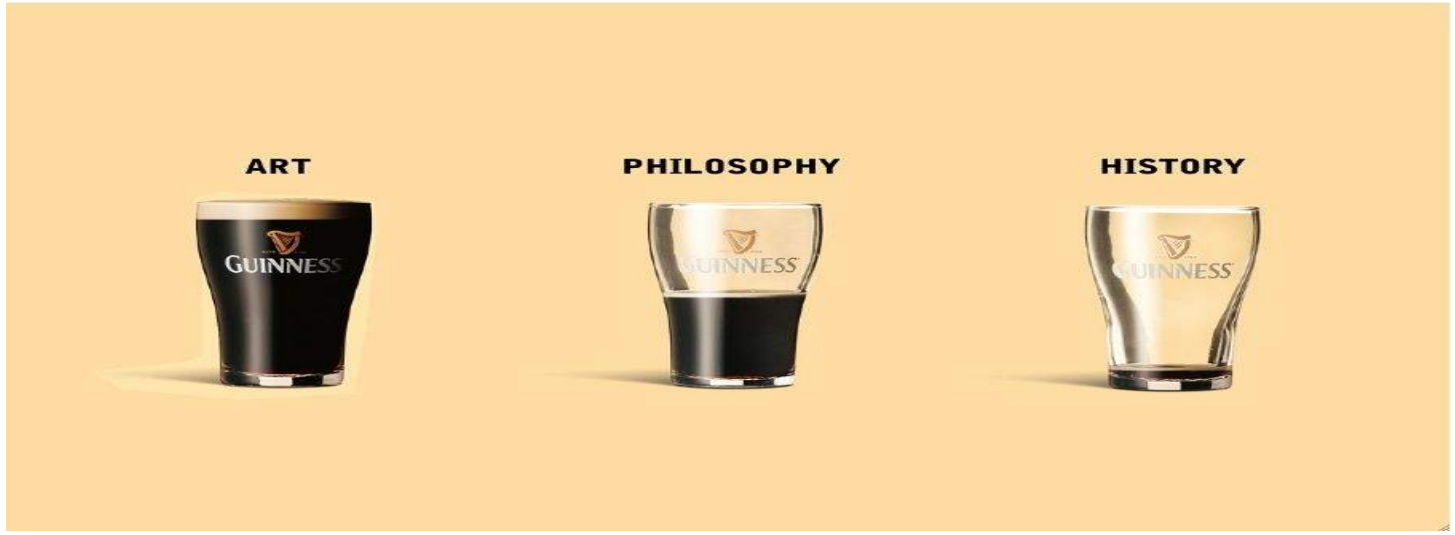
Philosophy



AESTHETICS

Philosophy of Art and Beauty





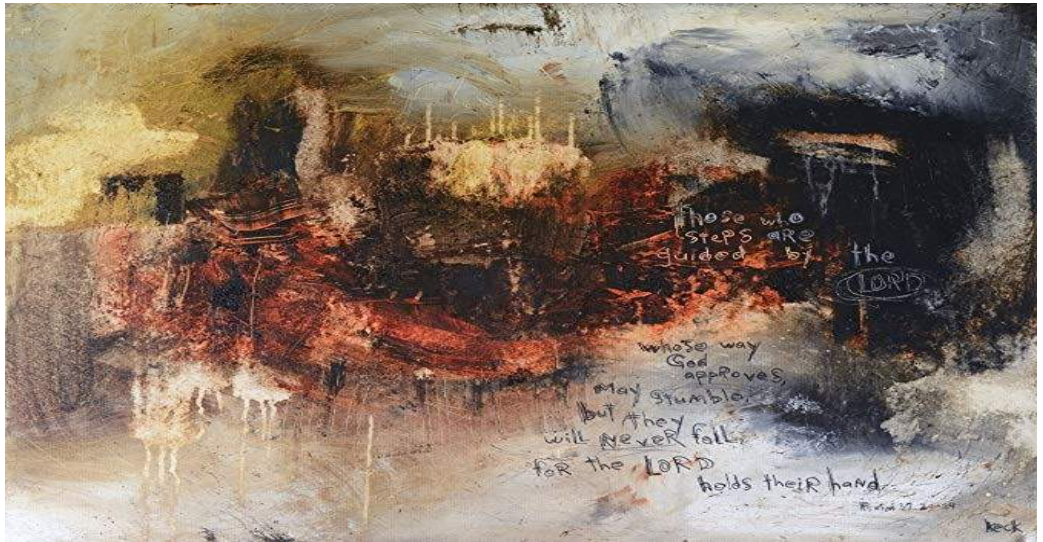
lecturer: SNA(Syed Noman Ali)

1. Explain the various philosophical approaches to art and beauty.

2. Analyze the various philosophical issues related to Aesthetics.

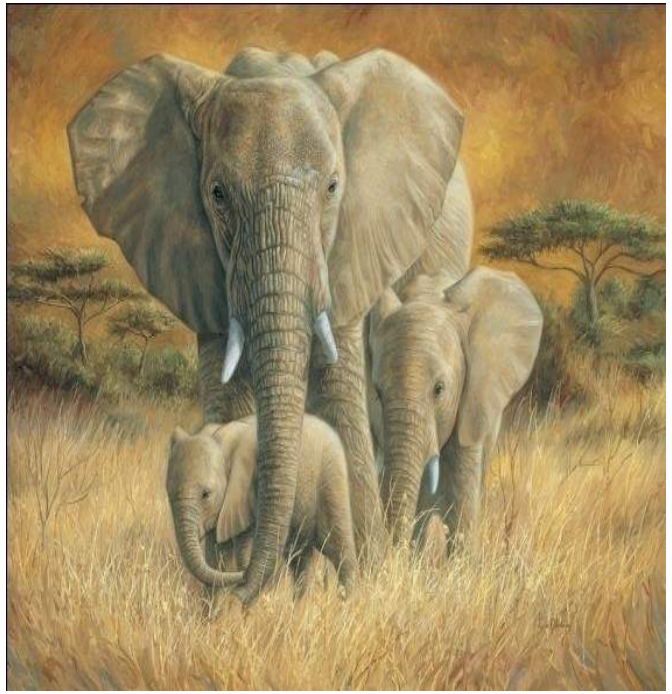
3. Develop an understanding of objectivity/subjectivity concepts of art and beauty





AESTHETICS: DEFINITION

1. a particular taste for, or approach to, what is pleasing to the senses especially sight;
2. a branch of philosophy dealing with the nature of art and beauty;
3. a particular theory or conception of beauty or art.



- Branch of Axiology
- (Value judgment)

- Study the nature of

Art

Beauty

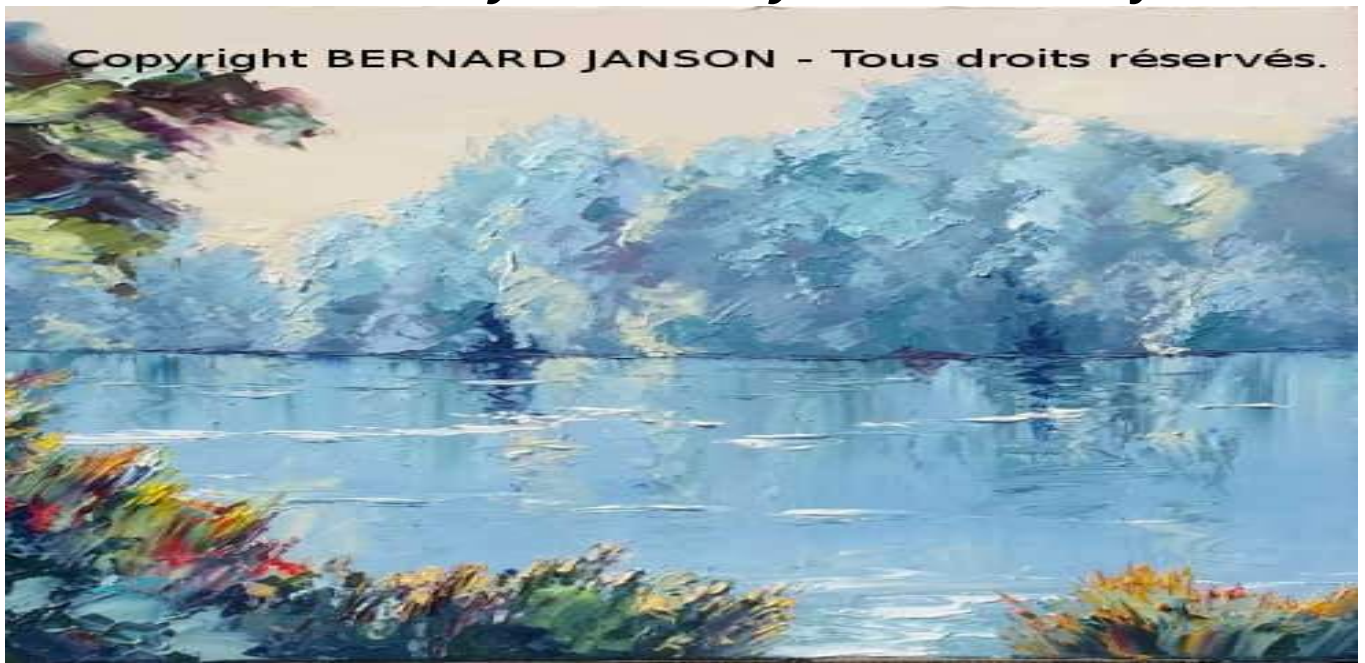
&

Taste



What is an Art ?

- *Art is a way not a thing just for the sake of art.*
- *Art is an expression of thought and emotion.*
- *Art is a discovery of beauty of nature* by *connects the people together*



Beauty is ….

“the qualities that give pleasure to the senses and characteristic of a person, place, object or idea that provides a perceptual experience of pleasure, meaning Or satisfaction.”

- *Pleasure for senses*
- *possession of features*
- *Harmony with nature*
- *Order and proportion*
- *Perfection and originality*
- *Reflection of own existence*
- *Fulfillment of purpose*
- *An imitation of nature*
- *God as absolute divine*









IS ART & BEAUTY LIES IN THE EYES OF BEHOLDER

Subjective or Objective

OBJECTIVE

It is a matter of fact

Beauty is the property of the universe.



- Ex. If a statue is beautiful, then someone who does not like does not merely have different taste, they are actually wrong.
- Aesthetic view of objectivity was cosmo centric: man doesn’t invent beauty; he discovers beauty.
- Pythagoreans, pre-Socratic philosopher, the “father of numbers.” believed that everything was related to mathematics and that numbers were the ultimate reality.
- Harmony, proportion, and number are the objective basis of beauty because harmony derives from order, order from proportion, proportion from measure, and measure from number.
- “Order and proportion are beautiful and useful while order and lack of proportion are ugly and useless.”

Subjectivist
It is a matter of taste or choices.



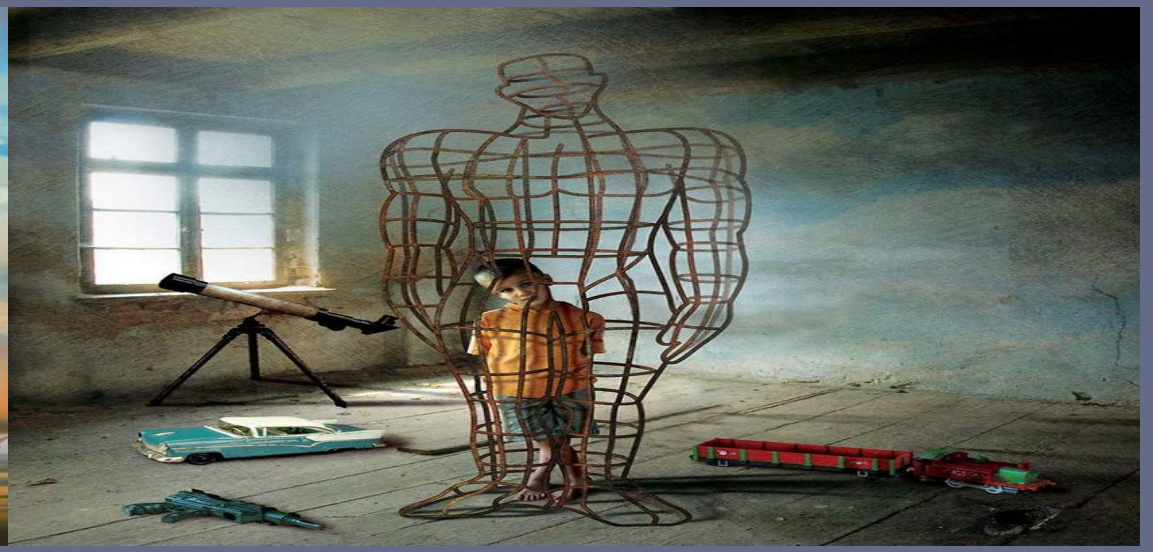
The same property is beautiful if it is the property of A and ugly if it is the property of B.
For example: A dress is beautiful on a lady, but ugly on a man.

- ***"Man is the measure of what exists"***
  Nothing else but the pleasure of the eyes and ears.
- The starting point was the relatively of beauty, which they extended to its subjectivity; beauty is a subjective experience.
- However our judgments on beauty are personal ones.
- By using our senses we then develop the notion of what is beautiful.









IS ART & BEAUTY LIES IN The originality or in imitation

Subjective or Objective

Art and Beauty is an imitation or reality ?

- *Plato*: art imitates reality. By focusing on mere appearances, art distracts us from the truth and appeals to socially destructive emotions. It provides no real knowledge and undermines personal and social well-being
- *Aristotle*: art does not imitate particular things; rather it identifies universal ideals and values. It also *purges* us of our erotic and aggressive passions (*catharsis*)



WHAT IS THE PURPOSE OF ART

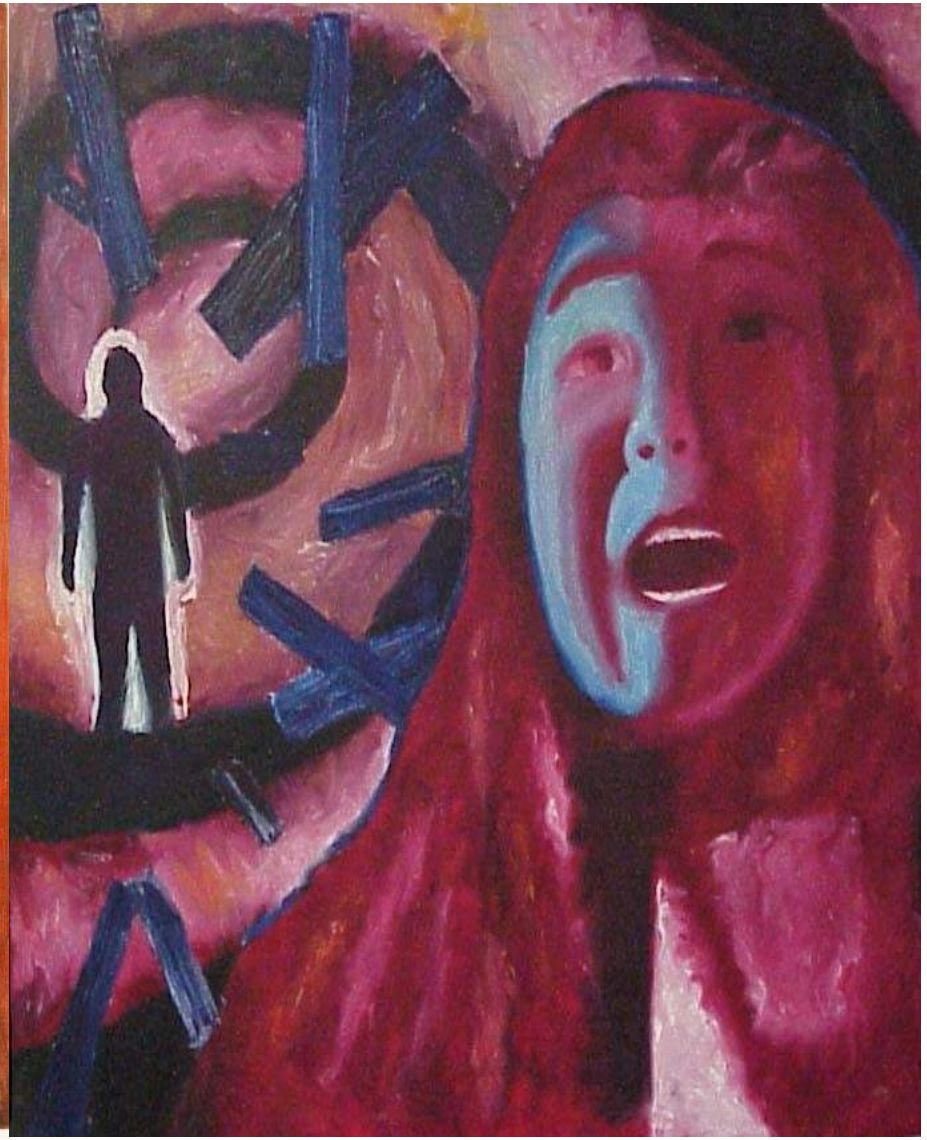
Art is a form of

A-Expressive

Art requires a strong communication of feelings, moods, or ideas from the work to the viewer.

art expresses or evokes feelings: it embodies the creativity of reality by expressing emotions





B-Religious

From the prehistoric cave paintings of France.

art has served religion.

For centuries the Church was the primary patron of artists.

In traditional societies even today, the primary purpose of art is religious or ceremonial.





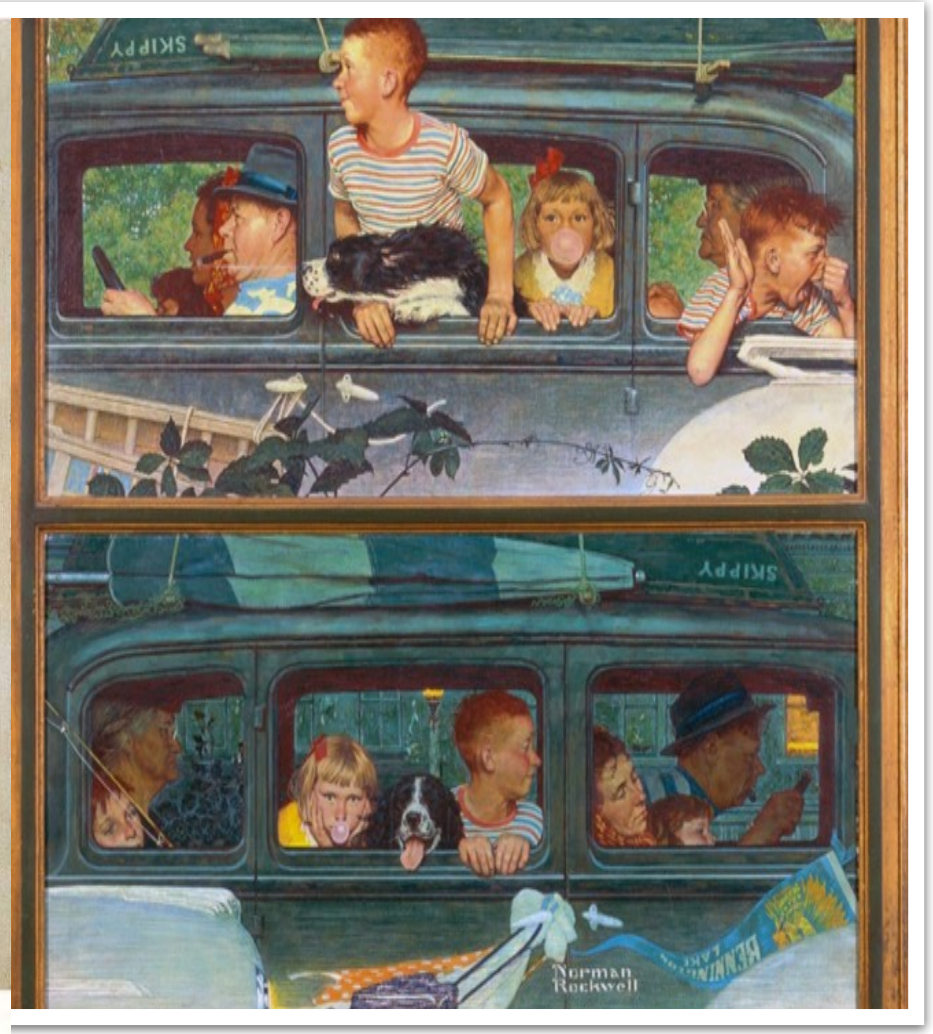


C-Storytelling

The artist as **social commentator** may simply make us more aware of the human condition as he/she perceives it, without suggesting particular action.



The Gossips, 1948



Theories of Arts

I. The Family Resemblance
II. The Significant Form Theory
III. The Idealist Theory
IV. The Institutional Theory



I- The Family Resemblance View

- Overlapping resemblance among family members without sharing any noticeable feature

- Same kind of resemblance exist between different kinds of Art.

Criticism:

- No common character
- Family resemblance view of art entails that art can not be defined







II- The Significant Form Theory



- Propounded by Clive Bell (1881–1964)
- All ‘genuine works of arts’ shared a quality; they have ‘significant form’ (structure)
- Due to this quality they arouse a strong aesthetic emotions in experienced critics

<u>Criticism</u>:

- Argument given to support the theory is circular
- Theory already assumes what it intends to prove

III- The Idealist Theory

- Associated to R. G. Collingwood (1889–1943)
- Art is defined as a non- physical idea in the mind of artist expressed in the different forms using different medium
- Difference between art & craft
- Art for the art sake; no purpose

<u>Criticism</u>

- Plausible
- Many great historical work of art created with a purpose are excluded as craft



IV- The Institutional Theory



- Art is defined by two qualities
  - i. They are artifacts
  - ii. They are considered as piece of art by members of art community

Criticism

- What criteria members of art world use to differentiate between;

i. Art & non-Art

ii. Good Art & Bad Art

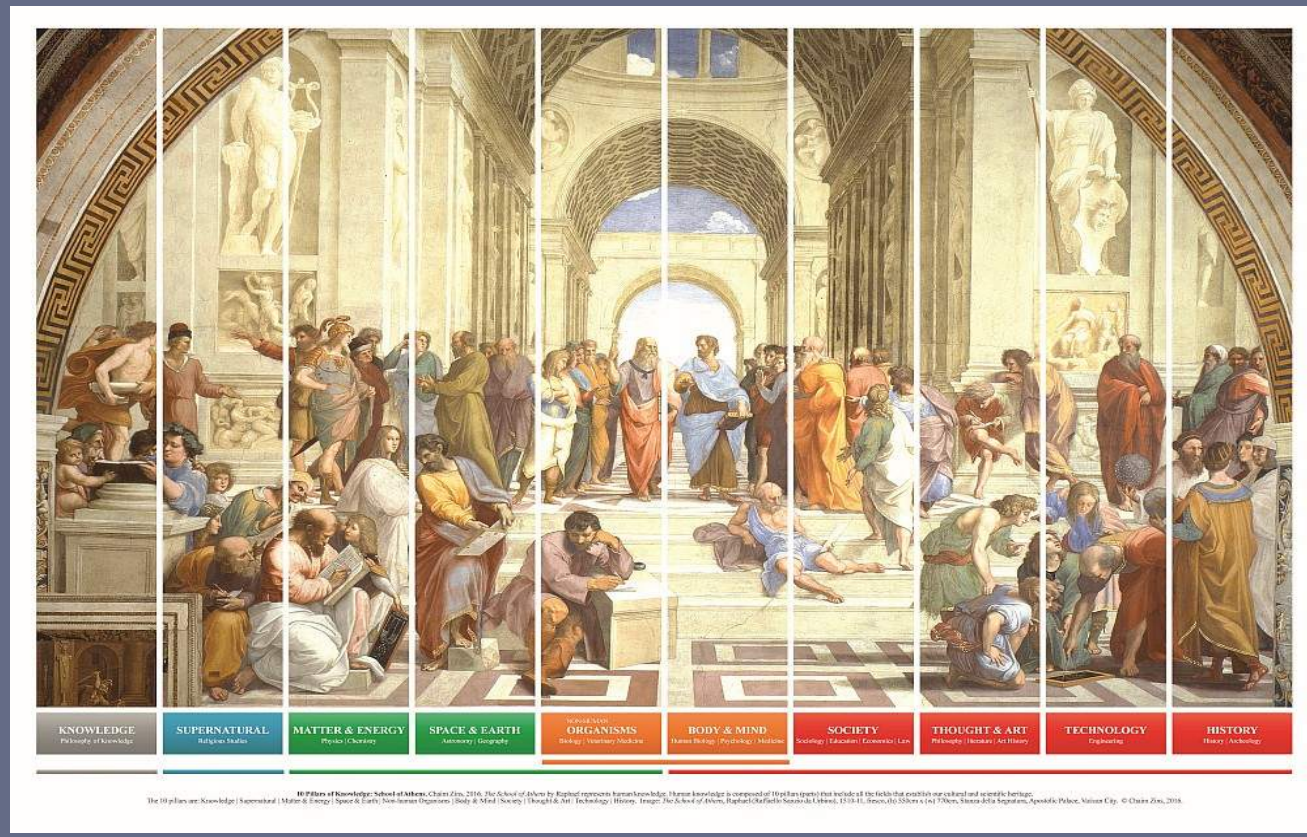
- Circularity





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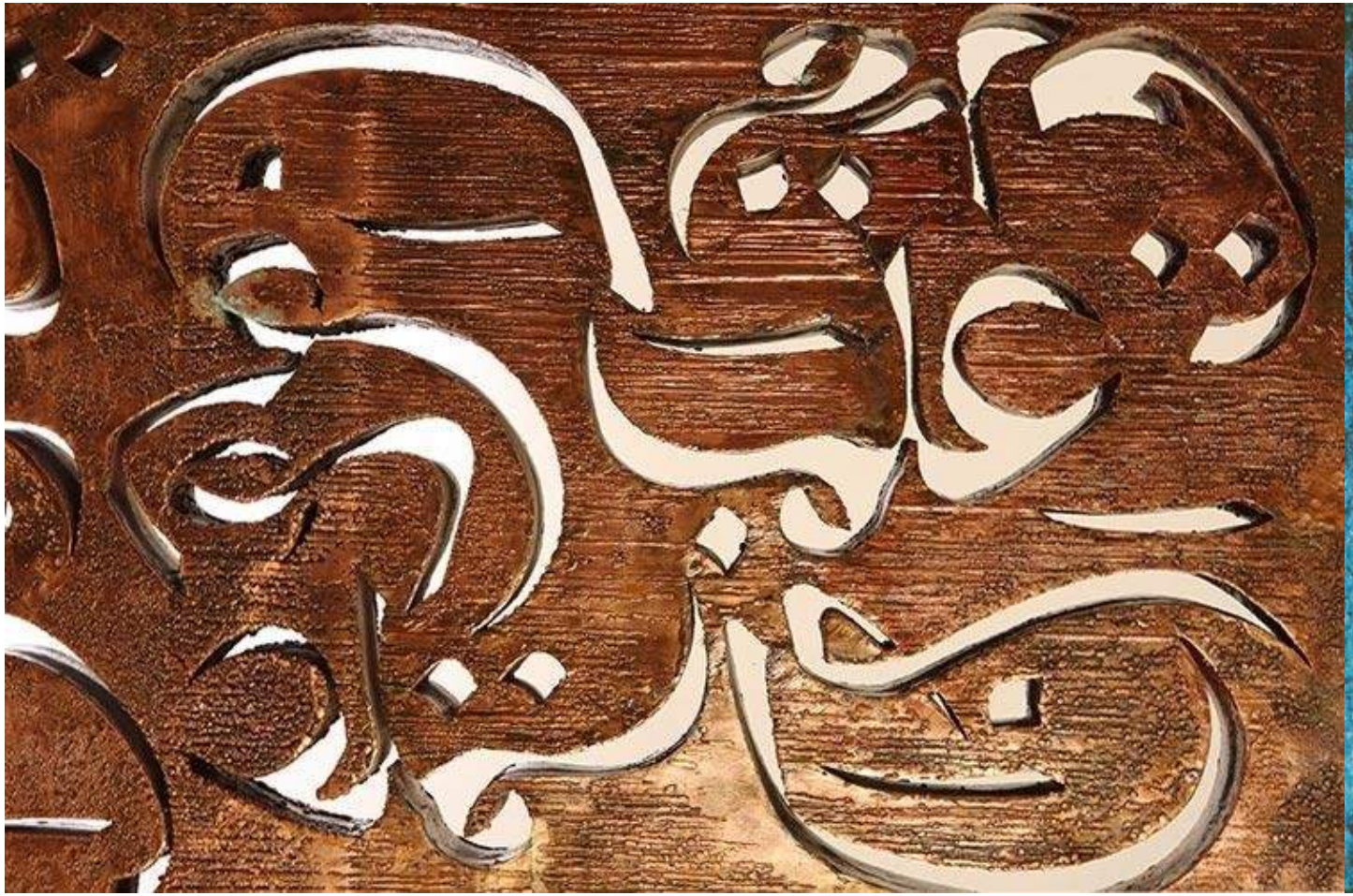
Warburton N, Philosophy: The Basics 5e, Routledge, Taylor & Francis Group (158-176)

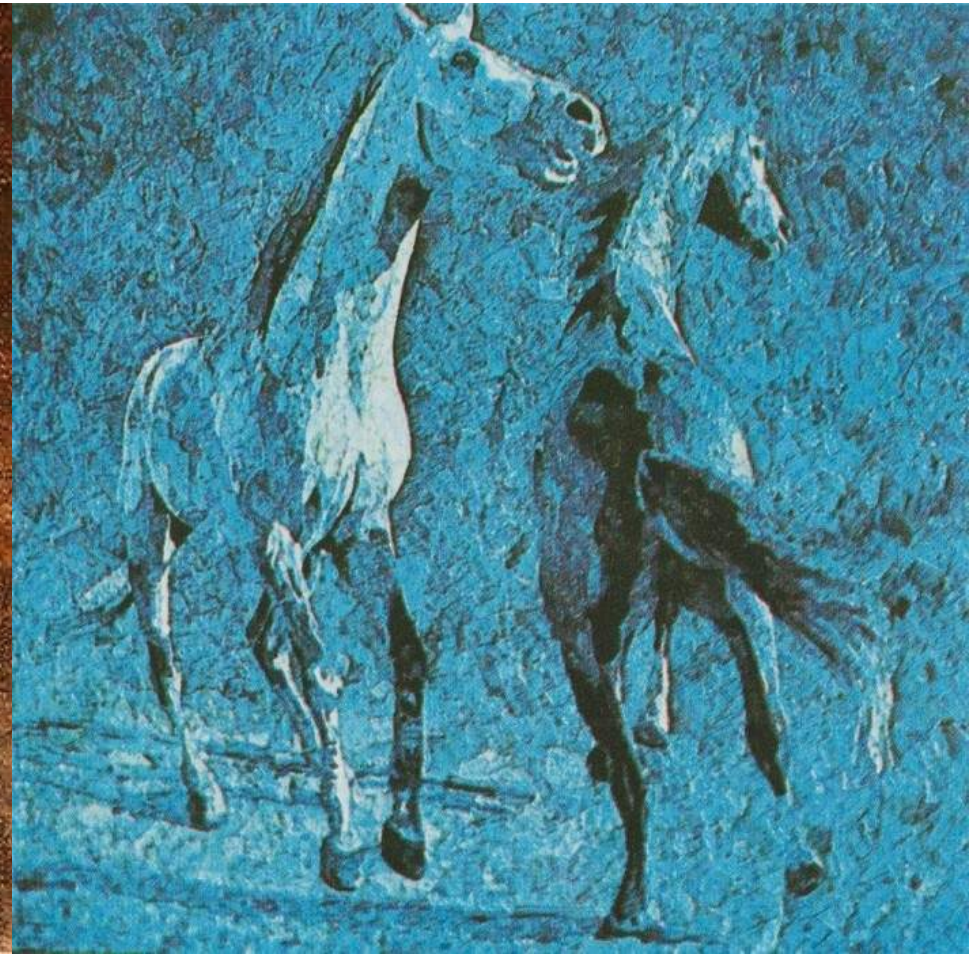




Popular piece of artwork

AMIN guljee





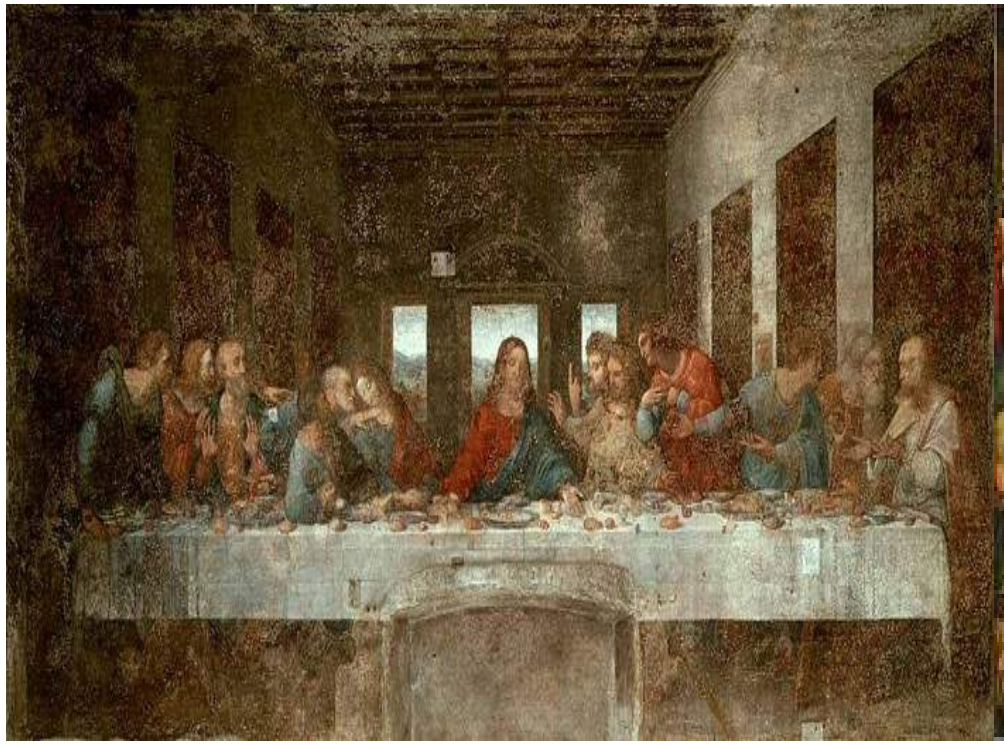
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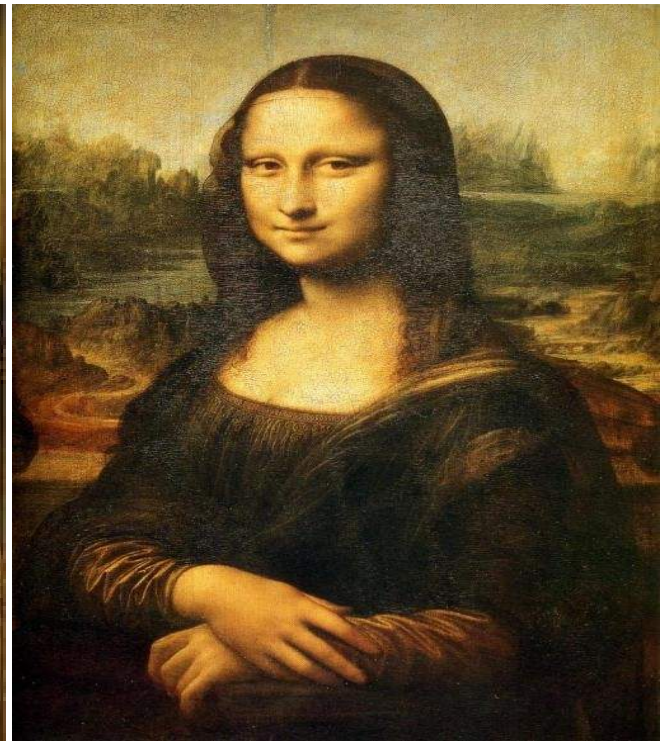




Leonardo De Vinci-
the last supper(1490)







Salvador Dalí-spanish
The persistence of memory(1931)



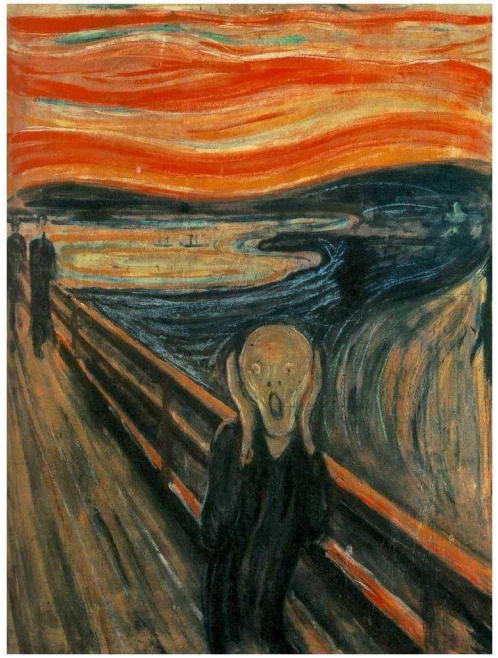
Johannes Vermeer

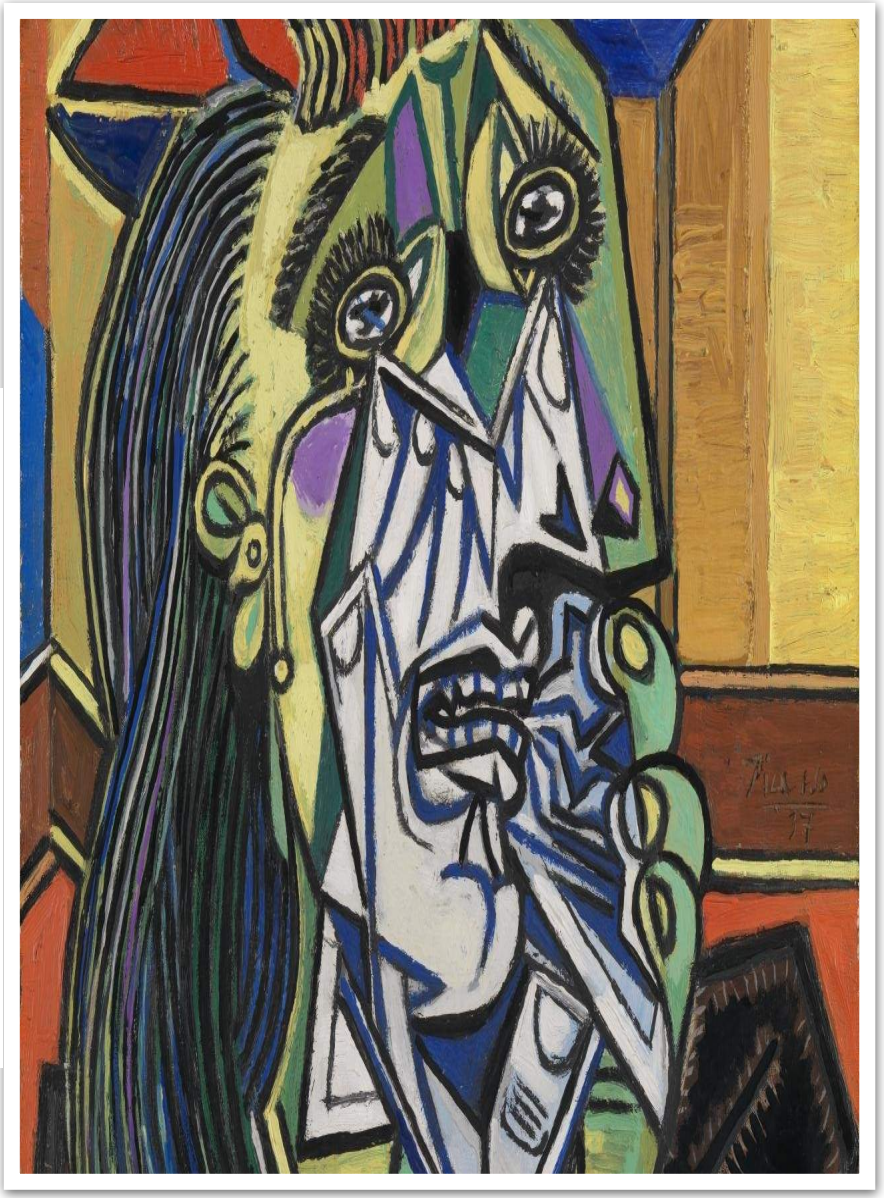
Girls with a pearl earring
(1665)



Pablo Picasso

WEEPING WOMEN (1937)





Vincent Van Gogh- Starry Nights (1889)



Michalengelo

Creation of adam (1508-1512)



